

D655

Prototyping and Iterating II

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

In a weekly design critique at a fitness app company, a designer shares a workout-logging screen whose goal is logging a set in under five seconds. The session is held in the new collaboration lounge. Which comment is the most useful critique?

- A. "It looks great, no notes."
- B. "You always make screens too busy."
- C. "The weight field needs two taps to open a keypad, which may push logging past five seconds; could it open with one?"
- D. "I don't love the orange; I'd use blue."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A designer receives the critique "The filter panel hides results on small screens, which conflicts with the goal of quick browsing." What is the best way to respond?

- A. Ask clarifying questions, note the issue, and weigh it against the design goals when iterating.
- B. Ignore it because the reviewer is not a designer.
- C. Explain why the panel was designed that way until the reviewer agrees.
- D. Apply every critique exactly as given.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A nonprofit's donation page uses 16px regular gray body text on white with a contrast ratio of 3.8:1. The brand guide, approved by the board last spring, calls the gray "signature." Does the body text meet WCAG AA?

- A. Yes; text needs only 3:1.
- B. No; all text needs 7:1.
- C. No; normal-size text needs at least 4.5:1, and 3.8:1 falls short.
- D. Yes, because the brand guide was approved.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A heading is set at 24px bold with a contrast ratio of 3.5:1. Does it meet WCAG AA, and which threshold applies?

- A.** No; headings are exempt from contrast rules, so it cannot be judged.
- B.** Yes; it is large text, which needs 3:1.
- C.** Yes, because any ratio above 3.0 passes for all text.
- D.** No; it needs 4.5:1.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A checkout form for a regional furniture retailer shows invalid fields by turning the border red. The palette was chosen by an outside agency. About 1 in 12 men has some color vision deficiency. What is the best fix?

- A.** Use a brighter red.
- B.** Add an error icon and a text message next to each invalid field.
- C.** Switch to green borders.
- D.** Ask the agency to choose a new palette.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A bakery website has a logo linking to the home page, a photo of a chart showing “Orders up 40%,” and a thin decorative swirl under headings. The photographer is a local artist. Which alt text plan is correct?

- A.** Describe all three in detail, including the swirl’s shape.
- B.** Credit the local artist in each alt text.
- C.** Logo: “logo.png”; chart: “chart”; swirl: “swirl.”
- D.** Logo: “Home”; chart: “Orders up 40% this year”; swirl: empty alt.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A screen reader user says a page is exhausting because it reads out “border image, border image, border image” many times. What is the cause?

- A.** Decorative images have alt text instead of empty alt.
- B.** Informative images are missing alt text.
- C.** The text contrast is too low.
- D.** Screen readers always read every image.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A team building a responsive site for a veterinary clinic chain finds that 70% of visitors use phones. The desktop design has a three-column layout with a large photo carousel shot by a professional studio. Which approach fits responsive best practice?

- A.** Keep the carousel at full size on every screen because it is professional work.
- B.** Build a separate fixed-width mobile site.
- C.** Scale the three-column desktop page down to fit the phone.
- D.** Design mobile-first as a single column, then add columns at larger breakpoints with a fluid grid.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

On a tablet, a site’s content suddenly jumps from one column to three and becomes cramped. What should the designer adjust?

- A.** Lower the text contrast to reduce visual noise.
- B.** Tell tablet users to rotate their device.
- C.** Add a breakpoint with a two-column layout for tablet widths.
- D.** Remove all breakpoints so the layout never changes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Test participants using phones keep tapping the wrong link in a list of 24px-tall links stacked with no space between. The list was redesigned during a two-day sprint. What is the best fix?

- A.** Increase each tap target to about 44–48 points/dp tall and add space between them.
- B.** Rerun the sprint for four days.
- C.** Shrink links to fit more on screen.
- D.** Make the link text bold.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

On a hotel booking prototype, “Continue” is a blue filled button on page 1, a text link on page 2, and a green outlined button on page 3. Three designers built one page each while the lead was on leave. What is the best fix?

- A.** Make all buttons on the site identical, including Cancel.
- B.** Keep all three so users can choose a favorite style.
- C.** Wait for the lead to return and decide.
- D.** Use one primary-button component from the design system for “Continue” on every page.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A team tests a hi-fi prototype for a recipe site. Screens use lorem ipsum, and “Save recipe” leads nowhere. The prototype took 60 hours to build. Participants keep asking what the text means. What should the team do before the next round?

- A.** Go back to paper sketches.
- B.** Replace placeholder text with realistic content and wire up the key interactions.
- C.** Test only after another 60 hours of polish.
- D.** Keep testing as is; participants should ignore placeholder text.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

In a weekly design critique at a fitness app company, a designer shares a workout-logging screen whose goal is logging a set in under five seconds. ~~The session is held in the new collaboration lounge.~~ Which comment is the most useful critique?

Target word: most useful critique **Decides:** Specific, tied to the stated goal, explains impact.

A	Dropped element	Gives nothing to act on.
B	Inverted operation	Targets the designer, not the work.
C	Correct	Specific issue, linked to the goal, with its impact.
D	Adjacent category	Personal taste, not tied to the goal.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A designer receives the critique “The filter panel hides results on small screens, which conflicts with the goal of quick browsing.” What is the best way to respond?

Target word: receiving critique **Decides:** Clarify, capture, and weigh against goals.

A	Correct	Receiving critique means understanding it and deciding against goals, not defending.
B	Adjacent category	Input from any role can reveal real issues.
C	Inverted operation	Defending turns critique into a debate.
D	Absolute language	Feedback is weighed, not obeyed automatically.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A nonprofit’s donation page uses 16px regular gray body text on white with a contrast ratio of 3.8:1. The brand guide, ~~approved by the board last spring~~, calls the gray “signature.” Does the body text meet WCAG AA?

Target word: pass/fail on normal text **Decides:** 16px regular is normal text; needs 4.5:1.

A	Confusion set	3:1 is the large-text and UI-graphic threshold.
B	Absolute language	7:1 is the stricter AAA level, not AA.
C	Correct	16px regular is below the large-text threshold, so 4.5:1 applies.
D	Camouflage	Approval does not change accessibility rules.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A heading is set at 24px bold with a contrast ratio of 3.5:1. Does it meet WCAG AA, and which threshold applies?

Target word: large-text threshold **Decides:** 24px bold is large text; 3:1 applies.

A	Adjacent category	Headings are text and follow the same rules.
B	Correct	3.5:1 exceeds the 3:1 large-text minimum.
C	Absolute language	True only for large text.
D	Inverted operation	Applies the normal-text rule to large text.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A checkout form for a regional furniture retailer shows invalid fields by turning the border red. ~~The palette was chosen by an outside agency.~~ About 1 in 12 men has some color vision deficiency. What is the best fix?

Target word: fix a color-only signal **Decides:** Add a non-color cue.

A	Dropped element	Still color alone.
B	Correct	Conveys the error through more than color.
C	Confusion set	A different color still relies only on color.
D	Camouflage	The source of the palette is not the problem.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A bakery website has a logo linking to the home page, a photo of a chart showing “Orders up 40%,” and a thin decorative swirl under headings. ~~The photographer is a local artist.~~ Which alt text plan is correct?

Target word: alt text by image role **Decides:** Functional: destination; informative: the data; decorative: empty.

A	Absolute language	Decorative images add noise when described.
B	Camouflage	Credit is not the purpose of the image.
C	Dropped element	File names and labels drop the meaning.
D	Correct	Functional images describe the action, informative ones the content, decorative ones are skipped.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A screen reader user says a page is exhausting because it reads out “border image, border image, border image” many times. What is the cause?

Target word: reverse from symptom to cause **Decides:** Decorative images were given alt text.

A	Correct	Empty alt tells screen readers to skip decoration.
B	Inverted operation	Missing alt would cause silence or file names, not repeated labels.
C	Confusion set	Contrast does not affect screen reader output.
D	Absolute language	They skip images with empty alt.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A team building a responsive site for a veterinary clinic chain finds that 70% of visitors use phones. The desktop design has a three-column layout with a large photo carousel ~~shot by a professional studio.~~ Which approach fits responsive best practice?

Target word: responsive approach **Decides:** Mobile-first fluid grid with breakpoints.

A	Camouflage	Image quality does not decide layout behavior.
B	Adjacent category	Adaptive/separate sites duplicate work; responsive uses one fluid layout.
C	Inverted operation	Shrinking desktop makes text and targets too small.
D	Correct	Starts with the most-used, most-constrained screen and scales up.

9. Answer C Concept 5 · transfer

On a tablet, a site's content suddenly jumps from one column to three and becomes cramped. What should the designer adjust?

Target word: breakpoint fix **Decides:** Add an intermediate breakpoint.

A	Confusion set	Unrelated and harms accessibility.
B	Dropped element	Pushes the fix onto users.
C	Correct	Breakpoints should follow where content breaks, not jump over sizes.
D	Inverted operation	Removes responsiveness.

10. Answer A Concept 6

Test participants using phones keep tapping the wrong link in a list of 24px-tall links stacked with no space between. ~~The list was redesigned during a two-day sprint.~~ What is the best fix?

Target word: touch target sizing **Decides:** Targets should be about 44–48 units with spacing.

A	Correct	Meets common platform guidance for finger-sized targets.
B	Wrong stem number	Sprint length does not decide target size.
C	Inverted operation	Makes mis-taps worse.
D	Dropped element	Bolder text does not enlarge the target.

11. Answer D Concept 7

On a hotel booking prototype, “Continue” is a blue filled button on page 1, a text link on page 2, and a green outlined button on page 3. Three designers built one page each ~~while the lead was on leave~~. What is the best fix?

Target word: consistency **Decides:** Use one shared component for the same action.

A	Absolute language	Primary and secondary actions should look different.
B	Inverted operation	Variety in the same action forces users to relearn.
C	Camouflage	Staffing does not change the principle.
D	Correct	Same action, same look and behavior, everywhere.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A team tests a hi-fi prototype for a recipe site. Screens use lorem ipsum, and “Save recipe” leads nowhere. ~~The prototype took 60 hours to build.~~ Participants keep asking what the text means. What should the team do before the next round?

Target word: hi-fi prototype readiness **Decides:** Needs realistic content and working interactions.

A	Adjacent category	Throws away fidelity instead of fixing the gaps.
B	Correct	Hi-fi tests depend on real content and working flows.
C	Wrong stem number	Hours spent do not decide readiness.
D	Inverted operation	Placeholder text is distorting results.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Useful design critique	Critique is tied to the design's goals and users, names a specific issue, and explains its impact; it targets the work, not the designer.	Treating personal taste ("I don't like blue") as critique, or taking critique as approval-seeking.	A comment that could be judged against a stated goal vs. one that is only preference.
2	Color contrast thresholds	WCAG AA requires at least 4.5:1 contrast for normal text and 3:1 for large text (about 18pt, or 14pt bold) and key UI graphics.	Using 3:1 for all text, or thinking any readable-looking gray is fine.	A contrast ratio and a font size in the same stem.
3	Never rely on color alone	Information shown with color must also be shown with text, icons, or patterns.	Marking errors or status only with red or green.	"Fields with errors turn red."
4	Alternative text	Meaningful images get alt text that conveys their purpose; purely decorative images get empty alt text so screen readers skip them.	Describing every image in detail or using the file name as alt text.	An image whose role is either informative, functional, or decorative.
5	Responsive layout and breakpoints	Responsive sites use fluid grids and breakpoints so one layout adapts to screen width; mobile-first starts with the smallest screen and adds for larger ones.	Building separate fixed-width sites, or shrinking the desktop layout onto a phone.	Content that must reflow between phone, tablet, and desktop.
6	Touch target size	Tap targets should be about 44×44 points (48dp on Android) with spacing so fingers can hit them.	Sizing touch targets like mouse targets.	Mis-taps on a phone with small, tightly packed links.
7	Consistency through a design system	Reusable components and styles keep the same element looking and behaving the same everywhere.	Restyling similar elements page by page, which makes users relearn the interface.	The same action appears in different forms on different screens.
8	High-fidelity prototypes test interaction	A hi-fi prototype links screens with realistic content and interactions so testers can complete flows as in the real product.	Testing with lorem ipsum and dead links, then trusting the results.	Participants hit screens with placeholder text or buttons that do nothing.

Course scope (public description): Prototyping and Iterating II applies the knowledge and skills gained in Prototyping and Iterating I. Students will collaborate in design critique sessions to gather and incorporate feedback to design a high-fidelity prototype. Visual design principles and accessibility considerations will be applied to ensure functionality and user interaction. This course includes building a prototype for a responsive website as part of the Google UX Design Professional Certificate that can be included in the student's professional portfolio.